

STATE OF NEW YORK

5587--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

February 25, 2025

Introduced by Sens. SKOUFIS, ADDABBO, HARCKHAM, HINCHEY, MARTINEZ, MAYER, MURRAY, OBERACKER, C. RYAN -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Consumer Protection -- recommitted to the Committee on Consumer Protection in accordance with Senate Rule 6, sec. 8 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the general business law, in relation to the calculation of interchange fees charged by credit card networks

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

Section 1. The general business law is amended by adding a new article 42-A to read as follows:

ARTICLE 42-A INTERCHANGE FEES

Section 1120. Definitions.

1121. Calculation of interchange fees.

1122. Rebate of fees on tax amount.

1123. Penalties.

§ 1120. Definitions. For purposes of this article:

1. "Credit card" means a card, plate, coupon book, or other credit device existing for the purpose of obtaining money, property, labor, or services on credit.

2. "Debit card":

(a) means a card, or other payment code or device, issued or approved for use through a payment card network to debit an asset account, regardless of the purpose for which the account is established, whether authorization is based on signature, personal identification number, or other means; and

(b) includes a general-use prepaid card, as defined in 15 U.S.C. § 1693l-1; and

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets [-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 (c) does not include paper checks.

2 3. "Electronic payment transaction" means a transaction in which a
3 consumer uses a debit card, credit card, or other payment code or
4 device, issued or approved through a payment card network to debit a
5 deposit account or use a line of credit, whether authorization is based
6 on a signature, personal identification number, or other means.

7 4. "Interchange fee" means a fee established, charged, or received by
8 a payment card network for the purpose of compensating the issuer for
9 its involvement in an electronic payment transaction.

10 5. "Issuer" means a person issuing a debit card or credit card, or the
11 issuer's agent.

12 6. "Payment card network" means an entity that:

13 (a) directly, or through licensed members, processors, or agents
14 provides the proprietary services, infrastructure, and software that
15 routes information and data to conduct debit card or credit card trans-
16 action authorization, clearance, and settlement; and

17 (b) a merchant or seller uses in order to accept as a form of payment
18 a brand of debit card, credit card, or other device that may be used to
19 carry out debit or credit transactions.

20 7. "Settlement" means the transfer of funds from a customer's account
21 to a seller or merchant upon electronic submission of finalized sales
22 transactions to the payment card network.

23 § 1121. Calculation of interchange fees. 1. The amount of a state or
24 local tax or fee that is calculated as a percentage of an electronic
25 payment transaction amount and listed separately on the payment invoice
26 or other demand for payment must be excluded from the amount on which an
27 interchange fee is charged for that electronic payment transaction. Such
28 taxes and fees include, but are not limited to:

29 (a) sales and compensating use taxes under article twenty-eight of the
30 tax law;

31 (b) hotel and motel and occupancy taxes under article twenty-nine of
32 the tax law;

33 (c) taxes on alcoholic beverages under article eighteen of the tax
34 law;

35 (d) tax on gasoline and motor fuel under article twelve-A of the tax
36 law;

37 (e) tax on petroleum businesses under article thirteen-A of the tax
38 law;

39 (f) tax on fuel use under article twenty-one-A of the tax law;

40 (g) rental vehicle taxes under article twenty-eight-A of the tax law;
41 and

42 (h) gratuities.

43 2. A payment card network may not alter or manipulate the computation
44 and imposition of interchange fees by increasing the rate or amount of
45 the fees applicable to or imposed upon the portion of a credit or debit
46 card transaction not attributable to the sales tax or gratuity amount or
47 other fees charged to the retailer to circumvent the effect of this
48 article.

49 § 1122. Rebate of fees on tax amount. 1. A payment card network shall
50 either:

51 (a) deduct the amount of any tax or gratuities imposed from the calcu-
52 lation of interchange fees specific to each form or type of electronic
53 payment transaction at the time of settlement; or

54 (b) rebate an amount of interchange fee proportionate to the amount
55 attributable to the tax or fee and/or gratuities.

1 2. A deduction or rebate must occur at the time of settlement when the
2 merchant or seller is able to capture and transmit tax or fee and/or
3 gratuity amounts relevant to the sale at the time of sale as part of the
4 transaction finalization.

5 3. If a merchant or seller is unable to capture and transmit tax or
6 fee and/or gratuity amounts relevant to the sale at the time of sale,
7 then the payment card network shall accept proof of tax or fee amounts
8 collected on sales subject to an interchange fee upon the submission of
9 sales data by the merchant or seller and promptly credit the merchant or
10 seller's settlement account.

11 § 1123. Penalties. A payment card network that violates this article
12 is subject to a civil penalty of not more than one thousand dollars per
13 violation and shall also refund the surcharge to each merchant or seller
14 from whom such fees were collected.

15 § 2. This act shall take effect on the first of July next succeeding
16 the date on which it shall have become a law.